these rocket engines was not restricted to the Prithvi project—it was a national achievement. Under their col ective leadership, a large number of engineers and technicians understood and committed themselves to the team goals, as wel as the specific goals which each one of them was committed to accomplish personal y. Their entire team worked under a self-evident sort of direction. Working together with the Ordnance Factory, Kirkee, they also completely eliminated the import content in the propel ant for these engines.

Leaving the vehicle development in the safe and efficient hands of Sundaram and Saraswat, I started looking at the mission's vulnerable areas. Meticulous planning had gone into the development of the launch release mechanism (LRM) for the smooth lift-off of the missile. The joint development of explosive bolts to hold the LRM prior to the launch by DRDL and Explosive Research and Development Laboratory (ERDL) was an excel ent example of multi- work centre coordination.

While flying, drifting into spel s of contemplation and looking down at the landscape below has always been my favourite preoccupation. It is so beautiful, so harmonious,